



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kootenai Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.kootenaiclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Kootenai Classical Academy (KCA) presents a robust classical-education profile, with strong alignment in curriculum, pedagogy, and parental/community partnership. Public-facing materials emphasize a liberal-arts orientation, Great Books, memorization and recitation, Socratic inquiry, and a formation-of-character ethos centered on truth, goodness, and beauty. The school also foregrounds civic virtue, self-government, and a Hillsdale College Curriculum framework, indicating a structured, tradition-minded approach to classical education. While explicit theological grounding or liturgical practices are not prominently featured in the public materials, the core classical aims—formation of character, pursuit of transcendent truths, and a living, intergenerational culture of learning—are clearly present. Overall, the evidence places KCA in the CLASSICAL category across most categories, with Element 1 showing some tension due to limited explicit theological/liturgical framing in public materials, but still strong in moral-realist orientation and virtue formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as real and desirable, and highlight virtue and moral formation as foundational aims. The mission states an objective desire for students to understand and desire what is true, good, and beautiful, and to cultivate character and civic virtue. Public pages also reference moral formation and the cultivation of virtue within a classical framework. See Curriculum and About pages, which articulate a formation-first, virtue-centered aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords identified on public materials include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; moral imagination; civic virtue; formation; moral order. Negative keywords (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics, non-theistic frameworks) are not evident in the public-facing text. Estimated presence: 5–6 positive keywords, 0 explicit negative keywords.
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- Why this rating: The school foregrounds transcendent values (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation, but public materials do not consistently present a grounded theological or liturgical framework. This yields a strong classical orientation in moral-realist terms, but only partial alignment with theological/liturgical foundations. Result: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Explicit articulation of formation over mere information; cultivation of virtue and wisdom; commitment to human flourishing; emphasis on timeless truths and beauty; aim for self-governing, virtuous citizens rather than job prep alone. Mission explicitly references "objects true, good, and beautiful" and "develop the minds and hearts" of students.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include formation, cultivation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé/ contemplation, great conversa-

tion. Negative keywords (workforce- or job-focused framing) are not evident in the public materials. Estimated: 6–8 positive keywords, 0 negative.

- Why this rating: The overarching purpose centers on character formation and the pursuit of transcendent ideals, aligning closely with classical aims of education as formation rather than vocational training. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Public materials describe an American classical education with a classical curriculum; explicit reference to Hillsdale College Curriculum; emphasis on liberal arts, Great Books, and foundational Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium; explicit mention of studying Latin and Greek; focus on history, Western civilization, and primary sources; emphasis on memorization and engagement with great books. Multiple pages reference great books, classical languages, and the Great Conversation. [filecite turn0file0 turn0file2 turn0file8](#)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; primary sources; Western civilization; history within curriculum; Latin/Greek; Socratic/dialogic pedagogy; memorization and recitation; wonder/integration. Negative signals (e.g., project-based learning-dominant or STEM-first framing) are not evident in the public-facing materials. Estimated: 7–9 positive keywords, 0 negative. [filecite turn0file0 turn0file2](#)
- Why this rating: The school marketably embraces the core elements of classical curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium mindset, Great Books, integration of history and humanities, memorization, classical language study), which justifies CLASSICAL. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The site and materials describe Socratic dialogue and dialectic, memorization/recitation (including chanting and poetry), and formation through imitation and practice; Restful learning/scholé concepts appear in the lexicon and in suggested pedagogy; upper grades engage in discussion and rhetoric, while lower grades emphasize memory and chants. The presence of “Socratic Method” and “great conversation” is explicit in the materials, and there are references to formal memory work and lyric/chanted learning. [filecite turn0file2 turn0file8](#)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, dialectic, recitation/memorization, chanting, restfulness/scholé, formation through imitation, rhetoric, and debates. Negative keywords are not evidenced in public materials. Estimated: 6–8 positive keywords, 0 negative.
- Why this rating: The pedagogical approach aligns strongly with classical methods (Socratic seminars, memorization, rhetoric development, and memory-based pedagogy) with some elements of restful contemplation, placing it in CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Public materials describe teachers as essential carriers of the tradition and values (the living curriculum; teachers as mentors; portraits of what a teacher should be). The school publishes faculty bios and highlights a culture of character formation and service; the mission emphasizes teachers who develop minds and hearts; there is a sense of a professional, stable, and values-centered faculty driving the education. The “Faculty and Staff” page showcases named faculty and roles, reflecting a structured, mission-aligned personnel pool. [filecite turn0file4 turn0file6](#)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, mentors, exemplars, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, and moral exemplars. Negative keywords are not evident. Estimated: 4–6 positive keywords, 0 negative.
- Why this rating: The faculty framing emphasizes virtue modeling, mentorship, and living exemplars, which matches classical expectations for the faculty category. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental involvement; it invites parent participation (Parent Informational Meetings), and it positions parents as co-educators with the school. Public materials discuss community and parent engagement as part of the classical model, including open campus opportunities and family involvement in the school's ethos. Enrollment communications highlight parental participation and engagement in the educational journey. [filecite\turn0file18\turn0file11](#)
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families; parent formation; home-school collaboration; parent involvement; open campus. Negative signals (consumer language, minimal parent involvement) are not evident in the public materials. Estimated: 4–6 positive keywords, 0 negative.
- Why this rating: The school's emphasis on parent partnership and family formation aligns with classical expectations of strong parent-community engagement. CLASSICAL.

Overall Assessment

- Aggregate category ratings: Element 1 (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL); Categories 2–6 (CLASSICAL). The pattern shows a solid classical orientation across the curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement, with Element 1 reflecting partial theological/liturgical grounding in public materials. Given the majority of categories are CLASSICAL, the overall ranking is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle: Not applicable here since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. (If one were to further strengthen Element 1, explicit theology/the Liturgical/communal practices publicly highlighted on the site could push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL.)
- Executive takeaway: KCA demonstrates a coherent classical-education program anchored in formation, Great Books, liberal arts, Socratic pedagogy, and a community-centric culture. The Hillsdale Curriculum framing and public commitments to virtue, truth, and beauty indicate a strong classical identity, with minor room for more explicit theological/liturgical articulation in public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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